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Report Highlights:

Taiwan's soybean imports are forecast to moderate toward trend levels in 2025/26 and 2026/27 as adequate stocks and stable demand fundamentals support normalized purchasing patterns. Containerized shipments are expected to remain a key competitive advantage for U.S. suppliers, while crushers continue to utilize regional exports of meal and oil as flexible outlets for inventory management. Despite the food waste ban following Taiwan's first African Swine Fever detection, soybean meal demand is forecast to grow modestly as livestock consolidation and improved feed efficiency more than offset operations exiting the industry.

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OILSEEDS, SOYBEAN

Production

MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 soybean production are forecast at 7,000 MT, an increase from MY2024/2025's 6,000 MT, reflecting renewed success in encouraging soybean cultivation.

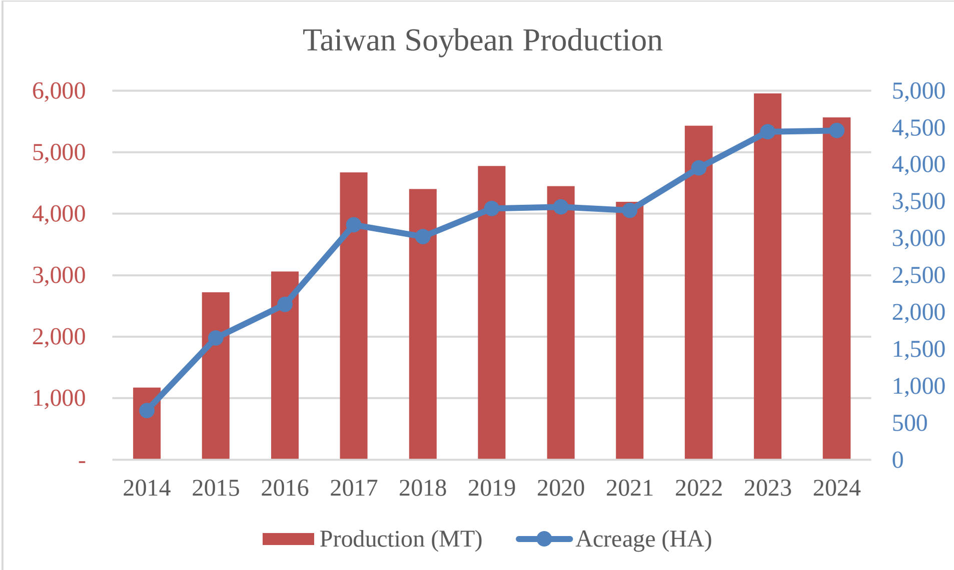
The 2025 second crop season marked an increase in soybean cultivation under Ministry of Agriculture's (MOA) "Comprehensive Upgrade Plan for the Grains Industry," a policy initiative designed to encourage farmers to switch from rice to alternative crops to better balance supply and demand. Among the 2,905 hectares total switched from rice to alternative crops, buckwheat accounted for 930 hectares, soybeans 503 hectares, and feed corn 96 hectares. The soybean expansion reflected the combined effect of December 2024's increased incentives (an additional NT$10,000 per hectare for alternative crops, concurrent with increased rice procurement support) and targeted support measures including offering soymilk from domestically grown soybeans as a lactose-intolerant alternative in school meal programs.

Despite this recent success, Taiwan's soybean production remains minimal due to the predominance of rice and other crops, lack of available farmland, and the competitiveness of imports. Since 2013, MOA's Agriculture and Food Agency (AFA) has offered subsidies for planting import-dependent crops in rotation with rice to decrease excess rice production and slightly reduce import dependence. However, planting expansion has been slow, with lower yields and lack of price competitiveness against imports limiting market opportunities for domestically produced soybeans.

Since 2022, AFA has made renewed pushes for domestically grown soybeans as a food security issue and encouraged the launch of the Soybean Industry Strategic Alliance to promote the domestic soybean value chain. In July 2023, AFA re-emphasized its intention to increase planted acreage by an additional 5,700 hectares over the next five years, which would increase total domestic production to about 14,000 MT (using average yields for Taiwan)—slightly more than five percent of domestic consumption if achieved.

It remains to be seen how much production might be further expanded given Taiwan's simultaneous efforts to increase alternative crops production including corn, buckwheat and sorghum. Due to higher production costs compared to imported alternatives, domestic soybean use is limited to higher-value products which promote local identity among conscious consumers.

Exhibit 1: Taiwan Soybean Production, 2014-2024 (by Volume and Area)



Source: MOA

Consumption

MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 domestic consumption are forecast at 2.72 million metric tons (MMT), stable compared to MY2024/2025 as soybean crush is sustained by feed demand.

MY2024/2025 consumption is estimated at 2.72 MMT based on sustained feed demand and stable crush operations.

MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 soybean crush are forecast at 2.1 MMT, unchanged from MY2024/2025. Domestic meal consumption, exports, and soybean oil demand have sustained the crush rate. However, the limited growth opportunity for vegetable oil consumption as well as constraints on further expansion of the domestic livestock industry continue to put a limit on future growth for soybeans.

Food Consumption

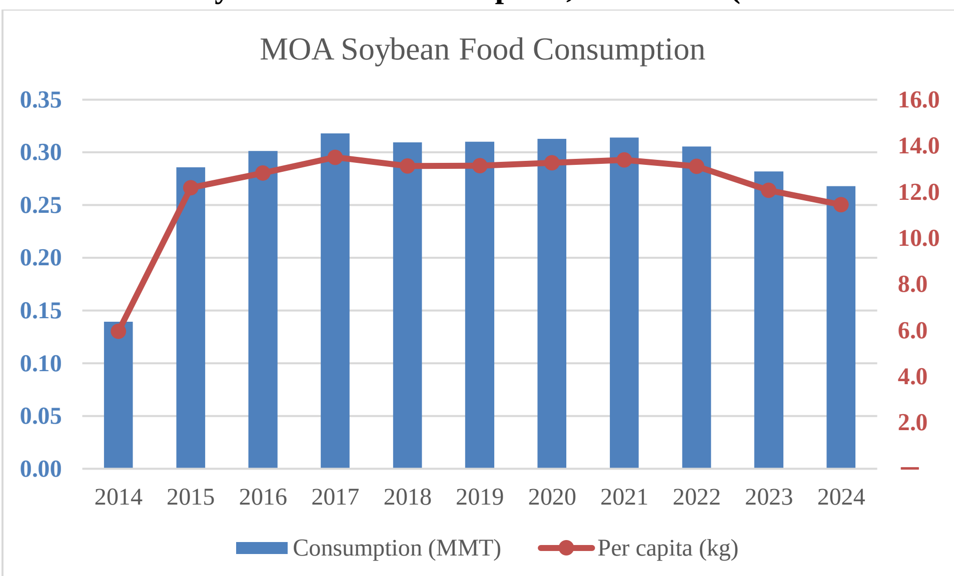
MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 food consumption are forecast at 320,000 MT, stable compared to MY2024/2025. MY2024/2025 food consumption showed a slight increase, evidenced by the rise in total soybean imports to 2.77 MMT (up seven percent) and the increase in non-GE soybean imports to 97,897 MT (up eight percent), reflecting modest growth in food-grade soybean demand.

Soybean food consumption has been relatively stable since 2015, with the largest components in the hotel, restaurant, and institutional (HRI) sector. According to Ministry of Economic Affairs (MOEA) statistics, food service sales in CY2025 grew approximately three percent year-over-year. However, like trends observed in other food sectors, this growth is driven more by price increases than actual increases in consumption volume.

Despite the recovery in the food service sector, structural factors constrain future growth in soybean food consumption. Foreign visitors to Taiwan continue to recover gradually, with inbound visitors growing approximately nine percent in CY2025 but remaining well below pre-pandemic levels. More significantly, outbound travel continues to grow faster than inbound tourism, with Taiwanese traveling abroad increasing over 12 percent year-over-year, creating a substantial tourism deficit. This persistent trend of higher outbound versus inbound travel poses a challenge to domestic food consumption growth as Taiwanese consumers increasingly spend their dining budgets overseas rather than domestically.

Taiwan's stagnant population, combined with the demographic shift toward an aging society and low birth rate, further limits potential consumption growth. These factors collectively suggest that soybean food consumption will remain stable rather than show significant growth in the coming years.

Exhibit 2: Taiwan Soybean Food Consumption, 2014-2024 (Total and Per Capita)



Source: MOA

Feed, Seed, and Waste Consumption

MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 feed, seed, and waste consumption are forecast to be stable at 300,000 MT, the same level as MY2024/2025. The main use in this category is full fat soybeans, which covers the remaining protein feed needs apart from soybean meal and other oilseed meal substitutes. Buyers would prefer full fat soybeans when vegetable oil supply is tight and prices are relatively expensive, while crushers would decide to supply full fat soybeans when the existing oil stock cannot further sustain production. Some of Taiwan's feed millers without associated soybean crush plants will also import soybeans directly to make use of full fat soybeans when it is economical.

Trade

Imports

Taiwan currently relies on imports to meet over 99 percent of its soybean demand. MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 soybean imports are forecast at 2.725 MMT and 2.75 MMT respectively, down slightly from MY2024/2025, as imports return to trend levels with adequate stocks and stable demand fundamentals. The United States and Brazil are expected to remain the primary suppliers, with market share dynamics continuing to reflect relative price competitiveness and logistics conditions.

MY2024/2025 soybean imports totaled 2.77 MMT according to Taiwan customs statistics, representing a seven percent increase from the previous year. The United States significantly regained market share, with imports surging to 1.51 MMT (55 percent market share), up from 909,000 MT (35 percent) in MY2023/2024, a 67 percent increase in U.S. soybean shipments. Brazil's market share declined to 42 percent at 1.17 MMT, down from 62 percent (1.60 MMT) in MY2023/2024. Canada maintained its position as the third-largest supplier at 70,000 MT (3 percent market share).

The shift in market share reflects improved competitiveness of U.S. soybean offers as U.S. prices became more competitive against Brazilian origins. Disruptions in global trade flows in early 2025 made U.S. Pacific Northwest (PNW) offers particularly attractive on a price basis, despite Taiwan buyers' traditional preference for higher protein Gulf Coast soybeans. This temporary shift to PNW shipments contributed to the surge in U.S. bulk volumes in the first half of MY2024/2025. However, as global trade patterns normalized in the latter half of 2025, Brazilian bulk offers regained competitiveness against bulk U.S. soybeans whether from PNW or Gulf Coast.

Policy Context

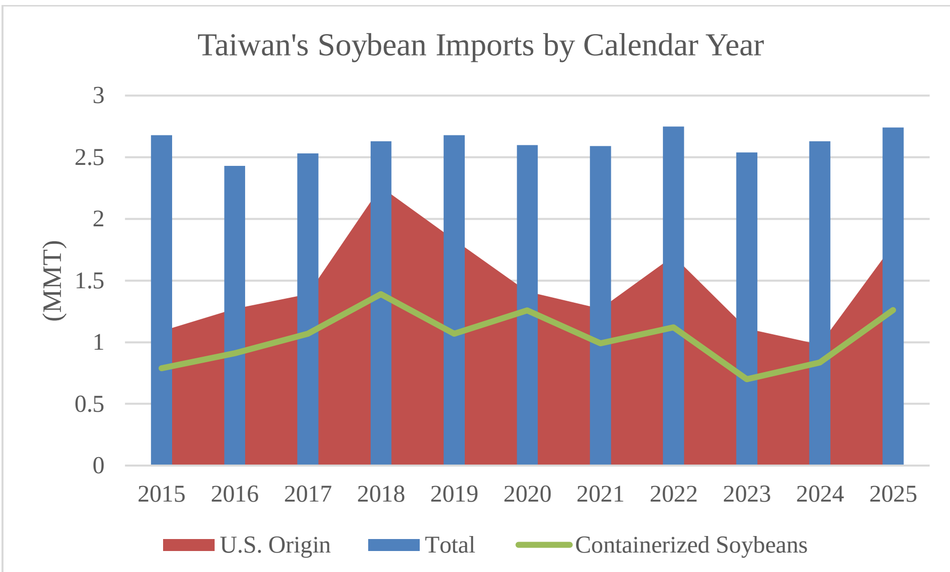
Taiwan relies on imported soybeans for both crushing and feed use. In February 2022, the government announced policies to waive the five percent business tax on corn and soybean imports as a measure to lessen inflationary pressure and stabilize feed prices. While the reduction provides only partial relief during periods of elevated grain prices, the measure continues to support both domestic crush operations and feed price stability. The measure has been extended multiple times, most recently for another six months, and is currently set to expire on September 30, 2026. Soybeans and corn, unlike wheat, already have tariff-free access.

Containerized Shipments

In CY2025, containerized soybean shipments totaled 1.26 MMT, representing approximately 46 percent of total soybean imports of 2.74 MMT, compared to 32 percent in CY2024. For U.S. soybean imports specifically, containerized shipments accounted for 66 percent (1.19 MMT out of 1.79 MMT total U.S. imports), down from 79 percent in CY2024. The decline in containerized share reflects improved competitiveness of U.S. bulk offers, particularly from the PNW in the first half of the marketing year. However, containerized shipments remained the dominant method for U.S. soybeans throughout the year, and when U.S. bulk offers are not consistently competitive, containerized shipments usually account for a larger share.

Containers offer significant advantages for Taiwan buyers: flexibility and discretion versus bulk vessels, the ability to use free time at port as temporary storage given Taiwan's limited grain storage facilities, and the preferred method for importing food grade and non-GE soybeans. Containerized shipping from the PNW remains a key U.S. export advantage, allowing buyers to arrange regular shipments and optimize inventory management. Taiwan remains the second-largest destination for U.S. containerized grain and oilseed exports (18 percent of total in CY2025), reflecting the importance of this trade flow.

Exhibit 3: Taiwan Soybean Imports from the United States and World, 2014-2024



Source: Taiwan Customs Statistics

Non-GE Soybeans

In MY2024/2025, imports of non-GE soybeans were 97,897 MT, an increase of 8 percent year-over-year. Canada increased both volume and market share, taking 70 percent (68,645 MT) of the non-GE soy market, up from 63 percent (56,772 MT) in the previous year, due to improved supply availability. The United States' share declined to 26 percent (25,441 MT) from 30 percent (27,436 MT). Non-GE exports remain heavily dependent on containerized shipments and supply availability.

Regulatory Framework (HS Codes Separate Feed or Other Use)

Since November 2014, Taiwan has required that GE and non-GE soybean shipments enter under separate HS codes. In May 2019, Taiwan further divided the codes for "other" or feed use. Soybeans are still imported mostly under "other" use, which has the flexibility to go into food or feed. In MY2024/2025, there were 63,188 MT of U.S. imports filed under the GE feed code, relatively stable compared to the previous year (62,155 MT). Imports under Feed or Other Use are subjected to different testing regimes at the border; imports under Other Use will need to follow the requirements for food use including Maximum Residue Limits (MRLs) for herbicides and pesticides.

Exhibit 4: MY2024/2025 Soybean Imports Breakdown by Customs Code (MT)

HS Code	Description	Volume (MT)
12019000916	GE Imports Other Use	2,598,306
12019000925	Non-GE Imports Other Use	97,897
12019000211	GE Imports Feed Use	63,188
12019000104	Black Soybeans	8,447

Source: Taiwan Customs Statistics; Trade Data Monitor, LLC

Black Soybeans

Black soybeans are widely utilized in Taiwan for food processing and manufacturing due to consumer preference for its supposed health benefits. This is the only category of soybean for which imports from China are permitted. In MY2024/2025, 8,447 MT of black soybeans were imported, with China supplying 5,833 MT (69 percent), the United States 1,813 MT (21 percent), and Canada 801 MT (9 percent). Taiwan has limited local production for black soybean (included in the soybean production statistics), mostly grown under contract, though domestic expansion faces the same challenges as regular soybean.

Stocks

MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 ending stocks are forecast at 164,000 MT and 201,000 MT respectively, while MY2024/2025 ending stocks are estimated at 152,000 MT. The modest increase reflects buyers maintaining adequate working inventory to support stable crush operations.

Taiwan has limited storage options for imported grains and oilseeds. The two storage facilities in Taichung and Kaohsiung port are shared among imported corn, soybeans, and wheat. With regular bulk shipments and containerized shipments arriving in Taiwan, storage at plants is also limited.

Oilseed, Soybean	2024/2025		2025/2026		2026/2027	
Market Year Begins	Oct 2024		Oct 2025		Oct 2026	
Taiwan	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Area Planted (1000 HA)	4	4	4	5	0	5
Area Harvested (1000 HA)	4	4	6	5	0	5
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	98	98	102	152	0	164
Production (1000 MT)	6	6	6	7	0	7
MY Imports (1000 MT)	2768	2768	2950	2725	0	2750
Total Supply (1000 MT)	2872	2872	3058	2884	0	2921
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Crush (1000 MT)	2150	2100	2330	2100	0	2100
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	320	320	320	320	0	320
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	300	300	300	300	0	300
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	2770	2720	2950	2720	0	2720
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	102	152	108	164	0	201
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	2872	2872	3058	2884	0	2921
Yield (MT/HA)	1.5	1.5	1	1.4	0	1.4
(1000 HA) ,(1000 MT) ,(MT/HA)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

MEAL, SOYBEAN

Production

MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 soybean meal production from crushing are forecast at 1.66 MMT, unchanged from MY2024/2025, based on stable crush operations. MY2024/2025 soybean meal production is estimated at 1.66 MMT based on stable crush operations.

Taiwan's annual soybean crush has fluctuated around 1.9 to 2.1 MMT in recent years. Crushers will optimize their crushing pace to keep their soybean meal and oil stock levels in balance. Crushing operations have consolidated with two large plants (Central Union Oil Corporation and TTET Union Corporation) and two smaller crushing plants (Everlight and Tai-Sugar). Daily combined crushing capacity is 9,000 MT with annual total capacity at 3 MMT. The average capacity utilization rate is around 65-70 percent. This utilization rate reflects the industry's operational equilibrium and is expected to remain stable in MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027, as limited growth in domestic feed and oil demand provides no incentive for capacity expansion or higher utilization rates. Taiwan crushers have developed export trade flows for soybean meal in recent years, which can serve as an alternative outlet when domestic demand is weak.

The soybean meal extraction rate remains stable and consistent with industry standards, with no indication of changes in crushing technology or processes.

Consumption

MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 soybean meal consumption are forecast at 1.63 MMT and 1.64 MMT respectively, showing modest increases from 1.62 MMT in MY2024/2025. The slight uptick is driven primarily by the ongoing shift from on farm to commercial feed and expansion of larger, more efficient operations, which offset the loss of demand from smaller operations exiting the industry.

Soybean meal consumption closely tracks annual feed production in Taiwan. Taiwan's feed formulation adheres to the ration of corn and soybean meal for energy and protein needs. Other meal alternatives including distillers' dried grains with solubles (DDGS) will substitute for soybean meal when there is a price advantage.

On a soybean meal equivalent (SME) basis, total protein meal supply in MY2024/2025 was approximately 2.25 MMT SME, consisting of 1.69 MMT of soybean meal supply (production plus imports), plus 300,000 MT of whole soybeans used for feed (240,000 MT SME), and approximately 316,000 MT SME from meal substitutes. Combined, soybean-based protein (meal and whole beans) accounts for 86 percent of total protein supply, with meal substitutes constituting the remaining 14 percent. The largest components of meal substitutes were fishmeal at 175,000 MT SME (with high protein content that is not easily substitutable) and DDGS at 130,000 MT SME, with minor contributions from rapeseed, copra, and peanut meals.

Meal substitute use declined 8 percent over the past three years to 316,000 MT SME in MY2024/2025, primarily due to reduced DDGS use as price competitiveness against soybean meal weakened. This dominant position of soybean-based protein reflects Taiwan's established feed formulation practices and reliable soybean import supply chains. The structural nature of this dominance is expected to remain stable in MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027, as Taiwan's feed industry favors consistency over short-term substitution.

Feed Production Trends and Demand Outlook

According to MOA's 2024 Annual Feed Survey, Taiwan feed production was 8.35 MMT, down slightly from 8.37 MMT in 2023. Poultry feed dominates Taiwan's feed sector, accounting for 50 percent of total production at 4.20 MMT in 2024, up 2.5 percent from 2023, reflecting the sector's recovery from the 2023 HPAI outbreak. Hog feed represents 41 percent of total production at 3.41 MMT, down 3 percent from 2023, as the sector faced disease challenges including PRRS and PED. The remaining 9 percent consists of cattle feed (3 percent), aquaculture feed (5 percent), and other animal feed (less than 1 percent).

Commercial feed's share increased from 71 percent in 2023 to 73 percent in 2024, reflecting continued consolidation in the livestock industry. The shift from on-farm to commercial feed has accelerated significantly over the past five years, with on-farm feed production declining 20 percent from 2.84 MMT in 2019 to 2.27 MMT in 2024, while commercial feed increased 5 percent from 5.79 MMT to 6.08 MMT over the same period. This consolidation is particularly pronounced in the hog sector, where on-farm feed declined from 2.43 MMT in 2019 to 2.01 MMT in 2024 (a 17 percent reduction), while commercial hog feed increased from 1.30 MMT to 1.40 MMT. The ongoing shift toward commercial feed directly supports soybean meal demand, as commercial formulations rely more heavily on soybean meal for protein compared to on-farm feeding practices that may use alternative protein sources or food waste.

Exhibit 5: Taiwan Feed Production (MMT)

Year	Total Feed	Commercial Feed				On-Farm Feed			
		Total	Hog	Poultry	Other*	Total	Hog	Poultry	Other*
2019	8.63	5.79	1.30	3.82	0.66	2.84	2.43	0.28	0.13
2020	8.64	5.81	1.34	3.82	0.65	2.83	2.48	0.23	0.12
2021	8.59	5.93	1.40	3.91	0.61	2.66	2.35	0.18	0.13
2022	8.60	6.10	1.47	3.97	0.66	2.51	2.15	0.22	0.13
2023	8.37	5.91	1.40	3.86	0.65	2.46	2.11	0.24	0.11
2024	8.35	6.08	1.40	4.03	0.65	2.27	2.01	0.17	0.10

**Other includes cattle, aquaculture, and other animals; Source: MOA*

Overall feed ingredient demand growth is expected to remain modest in MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027, with soybean meal consumption forecast to grow less than 1 percent annually through MY2026/2027. The ongoing shift from on farm to commercial feed and expansion of larger, more efficient operations will drive modest growth in soybean meal demand. However, this growth is partially offset by operations exiting due to the food waste ban rather than transitioning to commercial feed, as well as improved feed efficiency and stagnant livestock numbers. The net result is steady but limited growth in soybean meal consumption.

Hog Sector: ASF Response and Food Waste Ban

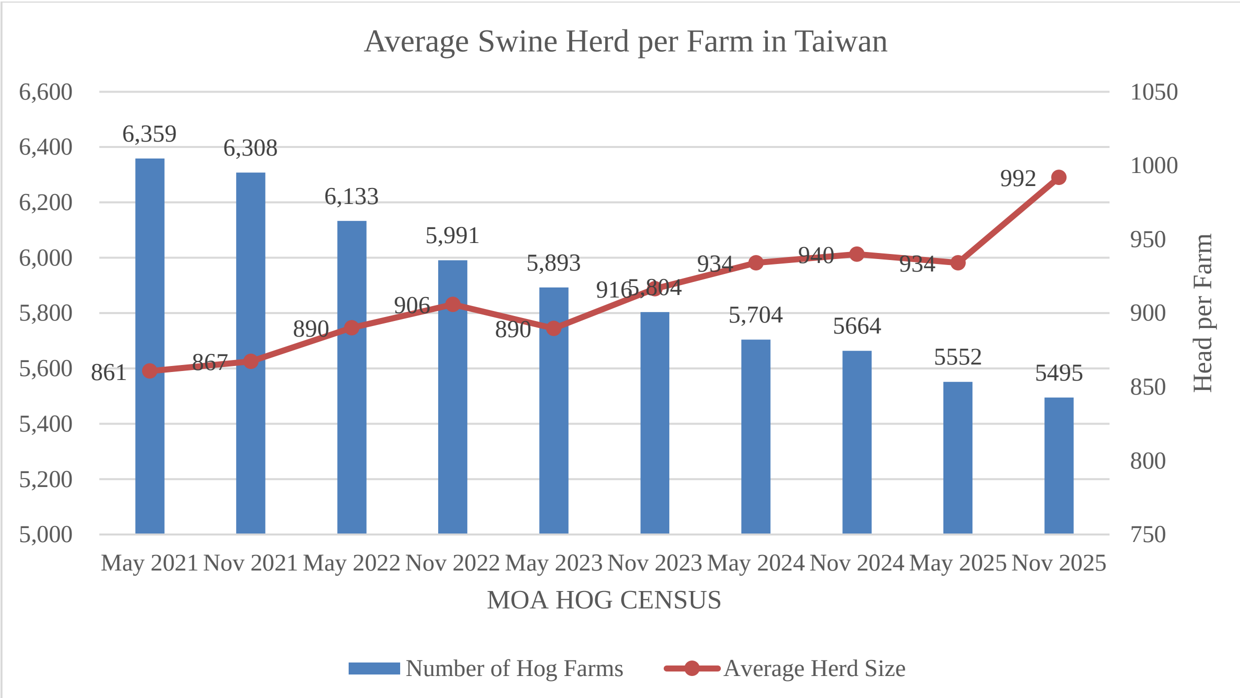
In October 2025, Taiwan reported its first domestic African Swine Fever (ASF) case at a pig farm in Taichung's Wuqi District, traced to unsterilized household food waste. While the outbreak was quickly contained through a temporary 15-day ban on pig movement and slaughter, it triggered a decisive policy shift. On December 4, 2025, the Executive Yuan announced a phased nationwide ban on food waste in hog feed: household food waste was immediately prohibited, business-derived food waste is permitted during a 2026 transition period under strict biosecurity requirements, and a complete ban takes effect December 31, 2026.

In 2024, approximately 483,000 MT of food waste (62.6 percent of total food waste) were used as hog feed, with about 8 percent of pig farms (435 farms raising approximately 470,000 pigs) registered to use food waste. Market sources indicate that food waste feeding represented a low-cost but highly inefficient alternative to expensive commercial feed. Specific plant-based business waste such as distillers' grains, fruit and vegetable residues, and bagasse will continue to be permitted even after the complete ban. Additionally, it remains unclear whether animal residues and slaughterhouse by-products will re-enter the feed system through further processing.

According to MOA's November 2025 hog survey, hog inventory stood at 5.33 million head, up 2.4 percent year-over-year, while the number of hog farms continued to decline to 5,495 farms, down 3 percent. The average herd size per farm increased to 992 head, up 6.2 percent, the highest growth rate in nearly a decade. The food waste ban is expected to significantly accelerate this consolidation trend. Market sources estimate the transition to commercial feed could impose cost increases of NT$3,000-5,000 per pig, which may prove economically challenging for many operations—particularly smaller farms and specialty black pig producers (approximately nine percent of hog inventory). While MOA is providing tiered subsidies to support the transition (NT$3,600 per pig for those switching before the end of 2025 and NT$1,800 per pig for those transitioning in 2026), some of these operations could exit the industry rather than transition, meaning a portion of pigs previously fed with food waste may not convert to corn and soybean meal-based diets, moderating the net increase on soybean meal demand. Larger, more efficient operations that already use commercial feed are likely to expand and maintain overall production capacity. For the first half of 2026, 93.2 percent of hog producers intend to keep their herd sizes stable, while 5.2 percent plan to expand. In 2025, Taiwan slaughtered 6.99 million hogs according to Animal and Plant Health Inspection Agency (APHIA) statistics, down 3.5 percent from 2024, partly due to the temporary movement and slaughter ban following the ASF outbreak.

Following the successful containment of the October 2025 outbreak, Taiwan applied to World Organisation for Animal Health (WOAH) in February 2026 to regain its ASF-free status. The affected farm was cleaned and disinfected, with samples testing negative in November 2025, meeting WOAH's three-month threshold for reapplication. Regaining ASF-free status would support Taiwan's ability to expand pork exports, potentially providing additional market opportunities for the consolidating hog sector while maintaining stable domestic production levels. However, the WOAH recognition process can be protracted and is not guaranteed, so any export gains are unlikely to materialize in the near term.

Exhibit 6: Taiwan Hog Farms and Average Swine Herd Size



Source: MOA

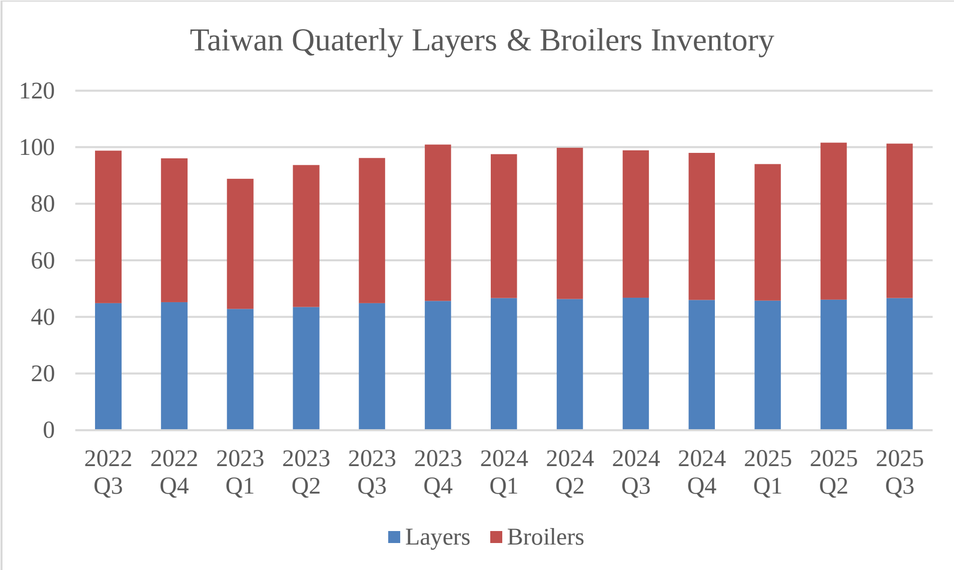
Poultry Sector Developments

The poultry sector has shown recovery from the 2023 High Pathogenic Avian Influenza (HPAI) outbreak. According to MOA's quarterly inventory data, layer inventory stood at 47 million birds in Q3 2025, stable compared to recent quarters, while broiler inventory reached 55 million birds, recovering to previous levels. This recovery is reflected in feed production data, with poultry feed increasing 2.5 percent in 2024 to 4.20 MMT.

However, HPAI remains an underlying concern. In January 2026, Taiwan confirmed H5N1 HPAI outbreaks at several poultry farms across multiple counties, resulting in culling activities. The outbreaks were concentrated in layer and broiler operations, with timing coinciding with the peak consumption period around the Lunar New Year. The period from October to March represents the peak season for avian influenza outbreaks. While the current outbreak appears to be under control through rapid culling and biosecurity measures, the recurring nature of HPAI continues to pose structural challenges to the poultry industry. The impact on feed demand from these outbreaks is typically short-term, as farms restock relatively quickly once biosecurity clearances are obtained.

In 2025, Taiwan slaughtered 400 million birds according to APHIA statistics, down three percent from 2024, reflecting the impact of HPAI outbreaks and culling activities throughout the year. Despite these short-term disruptions, overall poultry feed demand remained relatively stable as livestock inventories were maintained and restocking activities continued.

Exhibit 7: Taiwan Layers and Broilers Inventory (million head)



Source: MOA

Trade

Imports

MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 soybean meal imports are forecast at 40,000 MT and 50,000 MT respectively, up from MY2024/2025, as imports stabilize at moderate levels with domestic crush operations adequately meeting demand and occasional arbitrage opportunities.

In MY2024/2025, soybean meal imports decreased to 33,720 MT, down 58 percent from the previous year's 80,831 MT. The United States accounted for 52 percent of that volume at 17,509 MT, down from 60,419 MT in MY2023/2024. India emerged as the second-largest supplier at 12,818 MT (38 percent), up 11 percent from the previous year.

The significant decline in total imports reflects the limited arbitrage opportunities in Taiwan's domestic market. The majority of soybean meal supply in Taiwan is produced domestically. Because the domestic crush industry consists of only a small number of players, crushers actively balance supply and demand through production adjustments and inventory management, making soybean meal imports rarely profitable on an arbitrage basis. When domestic crush operations can adequately meet demand, import volumes naturally decline.

Taiwan does not possess the necessary port facilities or logistics to import or store meal-type feed ingredients in bulk. As a result, imports are containerized. The United States remains the main supplier of containerized soybean meal.

In the absence of any domestically grown meal substitutes, other protein meal substitutes come from imports. Meal substitute imports declined eight percent over the past three years, primarily due to reduced DDGS imports as price competitiveness against soybean meal weakened.

Exhibit 8: Taiwan Imports of Soybean Meal Substitutes (1,000 MT)

Meal/HS Code	MY 2022/23	MY 2023/24	MY 2024/25
2301.20: Fish meal	122	117	121
SME (x1.445)	176	169	175
2303.30: DDGS	242	232	223
SME (x 0.5833)	141	135	130
2306.49: Rapeseed meal	28	12	7
SME (x0.7115)	20	9	5
2306.50: Copra meal	9	6	5
SME (x0.4515)	4	3	2
2305: Peanut meal	2	3	4
SME (x1.124)	2	3	4
2306.60: Palm kernel meal	3	2	1
SME (x0.3557)	1	1	0
Total in SME	**344**	**320**	**316**
2304: Soybean meal	35	77	34

Source: Taiwan Customs Statistics; Trade Data Monitor, LLC

Exports

MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 soybean meal exports are forecast at 70,000 MT, moderating from the elevated MY2024/2025 level of 86,377 MT. The forecast reflects a normalization of regional supply-demand dynamics, with export opportunities remaining dependent on price arbitrage and availability of alternative supply in key markets including Japan, Vietnam, and South Korea.

MY2024/2025 soybean meal exports surged to 86,377 MT, up 72 percent from 50,273 MT in MY2023/2024. Japan remained the largest destination at 77,740 MT (90 percent of total exports), followed by Vietnam at 4,641 MT and South Korea at 1,867 MT. Both regular and higher-value fermented soybean meals are exported.

Stocks

MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 ending stocks are forecast at 14,000 MT, unchanged from MY2024/2025.

With a constant stream of soybean imports and limited storage space and shelf life, crushers can adjust their crush programs to reflect market demand and use exports as an outlet to manage inventory levels.

Meal, Soybean	2024/2025		2025/2026		2026/2027	
Market Year Begins	Oct 2024		Oct 2025		Oct 2026	
Taiwan	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	2150	2100	2330	2100	0	2100
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.7865	0.7905	0.7854	0.7905	0	0.7905
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	26	26	25	14	0	14
Production (1000 MT)	1691	1660	1830	1660	0	1660
MY Imports (1000 MT)	34	34	40	40	0	50
Total Supply (1000 MT)	1751	1720	1895	1714	0	1724
MY Exports (1000 MT)	86	86	50	70	0	70
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	1640	1620	1805	1630	0	1640
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	1640	1620	1805	1630	0	1640
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	25	14	40	14	0	14
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	1751	1720	1895	1714	0	1724
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

OIL, SOYBEAN

Production

MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 soybean oil production are projected at 378,000 MT, unchanged from MY2024/2025, based on stable levels of soybean crush. In recent years, Taiwan's soybean crush volume has been mainly driven by soybean meal demand. Soybean oil stock would act as a constraint on soybean crush when levels are too high.

The soybean oil extraction rate remains stable and consistent with industry standards, with no indication of changes in crushing technology or processes.

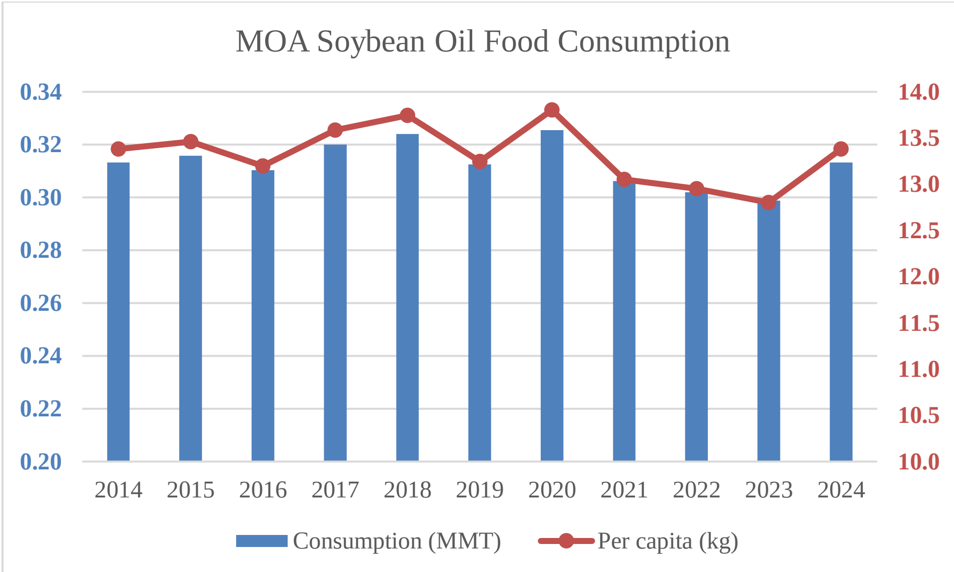
Consumption

MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 soybean oil consumption for food are forecast at 330,000 MT, down from 340,000 MT in MY2024/2025, as palm oil regains market share in the HRI sector. The forecast decline reflects the competitive dynamics between soybean oil and palm oil in the HRI sector, which includes restaurants, public cafeterias, and catering, where the two oils compete primarily on price.

Palm oil imports in calendar year 2025 have rebounded strongly, with first-half imports up 20 percent year-over-year, improving availability and price competitiveness. This recovery in palm oil supply, which is expected to continue through 2026, is expected to reduce soybean oil consumption to 330,000 MT in MY2025/2026, with consumption forecast to remain stable at this level in MY2026/2027 as palm oil maintains its regained market share in price-sensitive HRI applications.

According to MOA's Food Balance Sheet, soybean oil consumption in CY2024 was 310,000 MT (13.4 kg per capita), up slightly from 300,000 MT (12.8 kg per capita) in CY2023, consistent with the MY2024/2025 increase. In CY2024, soybean oil accounted for 69 percent of food-grade vegetable oil consumption (313,300 MT out of 452,700 MT total), while peanut and sesame oils accounted for 1 percent (5,200 MT) and 2 percent (10,400 MT) respectively. Palm oil and other imported oils accounted for the remaining 27 percent (123,800 MT).

Exhibit 9: Taiwan Soybean Oil Food Consumption, 2014-2024 (Total and Per Capita)



Source: MOA

For household consumption, health-conscious consumers usually prefer non-soy single oil alternatives (canola, sunflower, etc.) over blended vegetable oil products (including soybean oil), due to marketing and perceptions of quality. This market segmentation limits soybean oil primarily to price-competitive HRI applications rather than quality-focused retail channels.

Soybean oil consumption, like all basic commodities, faces limited growth opportunity as Taiwan's population has plateaued and is predicted to decline in the 2030s due to an aging population and low birth rate.

Trade

Imports

Taiwan relies on soybean crush for its soybean oil supply but imports a variety of other vegetable oils. Palm oil serves as the main substitute for soybean oil by volume in the HRI sector, with import dynamics directly influencing domestic soybean oil consumption.

Beyond palm oil, Taiwan imports a variety of other vegetable oils to meet consumer preferences. In MY2024/2025, canola (rapeseed) oil imports totaled 34,644 MT, sunflower oil imports reached 23,948 MT, and olive oil imports were 9,227 MT. These oils typically command premium prices in retail channels. Coconut oil (5,634 MT) and palm kernel oil (352 MT) serve specialized food manufacturing and HRI applications.

Exhibit 10: Taiwan Other Oil Imports (1,000 MT) (Oct-Sep)

Type of Edible Oil	MY 2020/21	MY 2021/22	MY 2022/23	MY 2023/24	MY 2024/25
Palm Oil (HS1511)	216	209	267	238	209
Canola (Rapeseed) Oil (HS1514)	35	40	32	25	35
Sunflower Oil (HS1512)	20	16	18	20	24
Olive Oil (HS1509; HS1510)	11	13	10	7	9
Coconut Oil (HS151311; HS151319)	6	6	6	6	6
Total Non-Soy Oil Imports	288	284	333	296	283

Source: Taiwan Customs Statistics; Trade Data Monitor, LLC

Exports

MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 soybean oil exports are forecast at 30,000 MT, rebounding sharply from MY2024/2025's 7,000 MT. The forecast reflects the role of regional exports in helping crushers manage domestic oil inventory as domestic consumption moderates. Regional markets, primarily Malaysia and South Korea, provide flexible outlets that enable crushers to sustain operations and optimize meal production without accumulating excess oil stocks.

MY2025/2026 shipments through February 2026 have surged more than four-fold compared to the same period in MY2024/2025, consistent with the forecast rebound. Malaysia has emerged as the dominant destination, absorbing nearly three-quarters of exports, while South Korea has maintained its position as a significant market. This sharp increase follows MY2024/2025's decline to 7,000 MT (down 76 percent from the previous year), when domestic consumption absorbed most available supply and limited export opportunities. South Korea was the top destination in MY2024/2025 at 2,587 MT, followed by Hong Kong at 1,941 MT and Japan at 891 MT, while Malaysia received only 506 MT.

By exporting surplus production through these flexible regional channels, crushers sustain crush operations driven by meal demand without building excess oil inventory.

Exhibit 11: Taiwan Soy Oil Exports (MT) (Oct-Sep)

(Selected)	MY 2020/21	MY 2021/22	MY 2022/23	MY 2023/24	MY 2024/25
Total Exports	18,169	29,246	43,146	28,542	6,954
South Korea	104	4,357	14,454	14,402	2,587
Hong Kong	9,152	8,116	6,536	7,169	1,941
Malaysia	1,094	1,878	15,182	3,002	506
Japan	1,520	7,775	4,620	1,016	891

Source: Taiwan Customs Statistics; Trade Data Monitor, LLC

Stocks

MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 ending stocks are forecast at 31,000 MT and 29,000 MT respectively, compared to 33,000 MT in MY2024/2025.

Crushers do not usually retain large inventories given limited storage capacity and high storage costs. The ability to export surplus soybean oil to regional markets provides crushers with flexibility to optimize crush operations based on domestic market conditions for both meal and oil.

Oil, Soybean	2024/2025		2025/2026		2026/2027	
Market Year Begins	Oct 2024		Oct 2025		Oct 2026	
Taiwan	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	2150	2100	2330	2100	0	2100
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.1786	0.18	0.1781	0.18	0	0.18
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	22	22	29	33	0	31
Production (1000 MT)	384	378	415	378	0	378
MY Imports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total Supply (1000 MT)	406	400	444	411	0	409
MY Exports (1000 MT)	7	7	30	30	0	30
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	20	20	20	20	0	20
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	350	340	365	330	0	330
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	370	360	385	350	0	350
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	29	33	29	31	0	29
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	406	400	444	411	0	409
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

OIL, PALM

Production, Trade, Consumption, and Stocks

MY2025/2026 and MY2026/2027 palm oil imports are forecast at 230,000 MT, recovering from MY2024/2025's below-trend level. The forecast reflects normalizing supply conditions and improved price competitiveness, enabling palm oil to regain market share in the HRI sector.

MY2024/2025 palm oil imports totaled 222,000 MT according to Taiwan customs data, down ten percent from the previous year due to elevated prices and supply constraints.

Palm oil benefits from a zero percent import tariff and competes with domestically crushed soybean oil primarily on price. Import volume variations directly reflect price dynamics and supply availability. Beyond the HRI sector, palm oil also serves food manufacturing and animal feed applications.

Taiwan imports almost all its palm oil as Refined Palm Oil and Its Fractions, with approximately 98 percent originating from Malaysia due to existing joint ventures with Taiwan companies. This longstanding arrangement is not expected to change.

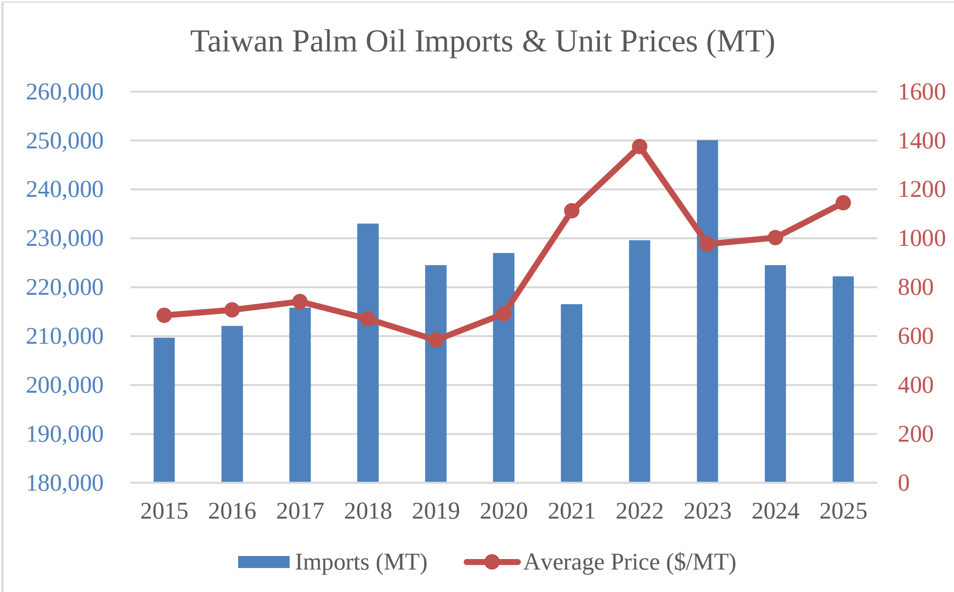
MY2024/2025 and MY2025/2026 ending stocks are forecast at 11,000 MT, stable compared to previous years, reflecting steady import flows and consistent demand patterns.

Regulatory Context

Taiwan's Food and Drug Administration (TFDA) has regulated the amount of glycidyl fatty acid esters (GEs), a suspected carcinogen, in food-grade oils and oil-based food products since 2024. GEs are contaminants that form during the vegetable oil refining process, including palm oil. The limit for GEs in food grade vegetable oils and fats is set at 1,000 µg/kg.

In 2024, there were two cases of palm imports that exceeded the allowed limit (one palm fat from UAE and one palm cooking oil from Indonesia). In 2025, there was one case of palm cooking oil from Indonesia found to exceed the allowed limit, along with several other refined vegetable oil violations from various origins. These cases have represented a small fraction of the approximately 220,000 MT of annual palm oil imports.

Exhibit 12: Taiwan Palm Oil Imports (Total Volume and Unit Price)



Source: Taiwan Customs, Trade Data Monitor, LLC

Oil, Palm	2024/2025		2025/2026		2026/2027	
Market Year Begins	Jan 2025		Jan 2026		Jan 2027	
Taiwan	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Area Planted (1000 HA)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Area Harvested (1000 HA)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Trees (1000 TREES)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	14	14	11	11	0	11
Production (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
MY Imports (1000 MT)	222	222	240	230	0	230
Total Supply (1000 MT)	236	236	251	241	0	241
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	225	225	240	230	0	230
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	225	225	240	230	0	230
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	11	11	11	11	0	11
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	236	236	251	241	0	241
Yield (MT/HA)	0	0	0	0	0	0
(1000 HA) ,(1000 TREES) ,(1000 MT) ,(MT/HA)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Attachments:

No Attachments